FAYETTEVILLE
DISC GOLF ASSOCIATION

A PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

# Walker Park & Kessler Park

Through a member-funded capital campaign, FDGA has raised **$18,538.94** for course improvements at Walker Park's Waxhaws Disc Golf Course — at no cost to the City. As a next phase, we're proposing a new course at Kessler Park that reuses the Walker Park baskets this upgrade replaces, built with volunteer labor.

| $18,538.94 | 1 | 1 |
|---|---|---|
| raised by FDGA members for Walker Park | course upgrade — Walker Park | brand-new course — Kessler Park |

PREPARED FOR

Parks & Recreation

City of Fayetteville

Fayetteville Disc Golf Association
A 501(c)(3) nonprofit
November 2026

OVERVIEW

# The Proposal at a Glance

> *Fayetteville Disc Golf Association is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit dedicated to growing disc golf in Fayetteville — maintaining public courses, running community tournaments, and providing programming for players of all skill levels. We do this work regardless of the outcome of this proposal; we're asking the City to partner with us in doing it better.*

### What we're asking for

- **Accept the gift:** $18,538.94 in new baskets, hole positions, tee pads, and signage for Walker Park, installed by FDGA.
- **Land at Kessler Park** to build a Gold-level course from the retired Walker Park baskets.

### What FDGA brings

- The full $18,538.94 campaign, at zero cost to the City.
- Professional course design by The Disc Golf Dojo ($1,000 per 9 holes).
- Volunteer labor to clear, build, and maintain — zero mature trees cut.
- Clinics, events, and cleanup days after it opens.

01 · THE GIFT

# FDGA's Capital Campaign for Walker Park

**$18,538.94** raised from multiple FDGA member donations, earmarked for capital improvements at Walker Park's Waxhaws Disc Golf Course — facilitated entirely through FDGA, at zero cost to the City. Once installed, every new basket and sleeve is City property, just like the existing baskets.

| ITEM | QTY | UNIT | TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|
| New baskets — MVP Black Hole® Portal<br>18 hole baskets plus 1 practice basket | 19 | $799.95 | $15,199.05 |
| New hole positions — permanent ground sleeves<br>Hot-dipped galvanized steel | 11 | $39.99 | $439.89 |
| Extended tee pads<br>Concrete work extending the existing Walker Park tee pads | — | — | $2,000.00 |
| New tee signs<br>Design and installation across the course | 18 | $50.00 | $900.00 |
| **Campaign total** | | | **$18,538.94** |



### MVP Black Hole® Portal

A 4-ring, 36-chain catch system built to absorb both soft and firm putts. PDGA championship approved, with a 20-year warranty against rust and corrosion. High-visibility royal blue — easier for road traffic to spot and for new players to find.

MVP Pro Shop product page



### Permanent Ground Sleeves

Each sleeve lets a basket move between multiple permanent pin positions, so layouts can rotate through the year — keeping the course fresh for regulars and giving FDGA more flexibility for tournament layouts.

MVP Pro Shop product page

**PROFESSIONAL COURSE DESIGN — KESSLER PARK**

FDGA is sponsoring **The Disc Golf Dojo** — the same local outfit already contracted by the City for disc golf programming — to professionally design the new Kessler layout, at **$1,000 per 9 holes**, so it's built right the first time.

02 · ALREADY IN THE PLAN

# The City's Own Plan Already Agrees

None of this is a new idea. The City's own **2023 Parks System Master Plan** — built on years of resident survey data — already documents the need for more disc golf, in the City's own numbers and in residents' own words.

✓

### Already a recognized partner

FDGA is already listed in the Plan among the City's recognized community recreation partner organizations — alongside groups like Fayetteville Youth Baseball and the Ozark Off Road Cyclists.

Source: Master Plan PDF p. 42 & p. 203

**IN RESIDENTS' OWN WORDS**

*"Not enough disc golf courses. It feels too crowded."*

Fayetteville resident, Master Plan survey — p. 342

*"Crowded disc golf courses a problem that the disc golf community would solve with their own time and effort if only given an adequate property to develop."*

Fayetteville resident, Master Plan survey — p. 336

All figures from the City's adopted *Fayetteville Parks System Master Plan and Appendices*, February 2023; page numbers as printed in the PDF.

2→3

## A documented shortfall

The Plan counts 2 disc golf courses citywide today — 1 per 46,975 residents, one of the lowest-served facility types the City tracks. Its own 2040 gap analysis says Fayetteville needs **3** just to hold today's level of service as the city grows: a shortfall of at least one course, already.

**Table 9:** Recreation Facilities

| Type | Current SF | Current LOS (Population per SF) | Current # of Facilities | Current LOS (Population per 1 facility) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Basketball Courts | 28,100 | 3.3 | 17 | 5,526 |
| Batting Cages | 9,800 | 9.6 | 24 | 3,915 |
| Handball Courts | 2,500 | 37.6 | 2 | 46,975 |
| Horseshoes | 14,000 | 6.7 | 20 | 4,697 |
| Skate Park | 20,000 | 4.7 | 1 | 93,949 |
| Tennis Courts | 49,400 | 3.6 | 5 | 13,421 |
| Junior Tennis Courts | | | 4 | 23,487 |
| Volleyball Courts | 26,400 | 1.9 | 7 | 18,035 |
| Playgrounds* | - | - | 25 | 3,468 |
| Baseball Fields | - | - | 18 | 5,219 |
| Disc Golf | - | - | 2 | 46,975 |
| Soccer/ Multipurpose Fields | - | - | 15 | 6,263 |
| Softball Fields | - | - | 8 | 11,744 |
| Lighted Fields (all sports) | | | 28 | 2,936 |
| Non-lighted Fields (all sports) | | | 9 | 10,439 |
| Pools | | | 1 | 93,949 |
| Splash Pads | | | 1 | 93,949 |

*Current Playground LOS is 520 persons per playground when counting just the population under 15 years of age

34 | Parks and Recreation Today

Source: Master Plan Table 9, PDF p. 44 & Table 14, p. 99

#1

## The most-mentioned ask

In the Plan's open-participation survey (461 respondents), **"disc golf" was the single most common topic** in open-ended comments on what to improve — 18%, ahead of natural-space preservation, requests for more parks, and every other category.

**Table 48: Question 12 (Open Participation)**

| What other comments or suggestions would you like to make about parks and recreation in Fayetteville? | Percent |
|---|---|
| Disc golf | 18% |
| Preservation, natural spaces, environmental causes | 17% |
| Add more parks | 14% |
| Parking, bathrooms, trash bins, amenities, and maintenance | 12% |
| Tracks | 9% |
| Swimming - pools, splash pads, water parks | 8% |
| Safety issues - homeless, camping, drugs | 8% |
| Trails, signage | 7% |
| Tennis, pickleball, volleyball, soccer, baseball, softball | 6% |
| River-based, frontage, park | 6% |
| Good job, continue the good work | 5% |
| Indoor facilities, gym, recreation center, senior center | 5% |
| Bike amenities, lanes, trails, bike park, bike safety | 4% |
| Playgrounds | 4% |
| Transportation, access, sidewalks, safety | 4% |
| Dog parks | 2% |
| Skate parks | 2% |
| Other | 16% |
| Total | N=461 |

*These categories were coded from the responses to the open-ended question, the full responses are available under separate cover.*

Source: Master Plan Table 48, PDF p. 358

03 · THE ASK

# A Gold-Level Course at Kessler Park

We believe that by removing only invasive privet and honeysuckle — and cutting **zero mature trees** — we can create a **Gold-level disc golf course** at Kessler Park, reusing the City's existing Walker Park baskets once the Waxhaws upgrade replaces them. Nothing goes to waste.

## Built around your plans

FDGA has identified wooded areas of the park for the course. We don't know all of the City's plans for Kessler, but we're committed to working around them — the course will be laid out so that whatever the City has planned can still happen. We'd welcome the City's input on where a course fits best alongside those plans.

## Good neighbors in the park

Fairways will be routed away from trails, pavilions, the sports fields, and parking, so players and other park visitors stay out of each other's way.

The **purple highlighted areas** on the map are the areas we'd like to use. They're open to the City's feedback before anything is finalized.




Proposed course areas. Final layout to be set with the City and The Disc Golf Dojo.

### A DESTINATION COURSE

**Great for locals, and worth the trip.** A Gold-level course would be a great home for Fayetteville's current players and a welcoming place for new ones to grow into the sport — and it would make Kessler a course that players travel to. Visiting players and tournament fields stay in Fayetteville hotels, eat in local restaurants, and bring **hotel tax revenue** to the City along with them.

**And a major is already on its way.** The PDGA has chosen Northwest Arkansas to host the **2028 PDGA Tim Selinske United States Masters Disc Golf Championships** — one of the sport's major championships, with Fayetteville named among the host cities. A Gold-level course at Kessler would put Fayetteville in position to welcome those players and the visitors who follow them, and to keep drawing events long after 2028. (PDGA announcement, Jan. 2026)

### ALREADY PROVEN AT KESSLER

**FDGA's Ice Bowl already brings players to Kessler Mountain.** Every year, FDGA sets up a temporary course at Kessler for its Ice Bowl charity tournament. A permanent course would give that event, and others like it, a home.

| 100+ | $6,000+ | Everhope |
|---|---|---|
| players at the Ice Bowl each year | raised every year for the last 5 years | formerly the NWA Children's Shelter |

### KESSLER WAS ALREADY ON RESIDENTS' LIST

In the City's own community engagement summary for the Master Plan, Disc Golf was named among the top requested uses for Kessler Mountain Regional Park specifically (14 responses, PDF p. 235).




Residents also asked for this siting approach: "Building and Development of Disc Golf Courses in non-flood plain areas so we can focus on ongoing development of fairways… without the constant setbacks due to flooding" (Master Plan survey, p. 321). That's exactly the wooded, non-floodplain site FDGA is proposing here.

04 · OUR PART

# Volunteer Labor

FDGA volunteers will help clear the site and build the course.

### Clearing the site

FDGA volunteers will help clear invasive privet and honeysuckle along the Kessler fairways — zero mature trees cut. We'd walk the site with City staff before any work begins.

### Building the course

FDGA will help design and build the course with The Disc Golf Dojo — pouring the concrete tee pads, putting up tee signs, and installing the baskets.

AFTER IT OPENS

**We'll help it succeed.** FDGA will help onboard new players at Kessler with intro clinics and course-launch events, and will keep the course clean with regular volunteer cleanup days — trash pickup, invasive removal, and basket upkeep — so it's a well-cared-for addition to the park, not another item on the City's list.

**And over the long haul.** FDGA will handle routine upkeep and lead fundraising for repairs and replacements as the course ages — baskets, signs, and tee pads — just as we've done with this campaign for Walker Park.

05 · NEXT STEPS

# What We're Asking For

1

## Accept the gift

FDGA's $18,538.94 capital campaign for Walker Park: 19 new baskets, 11 new hole positions, extended tee pads, and new tee signage — installed by FDGA at no cost to the City.

2

## Land to build a Gold-level course at Kessler Park

Built by FDGA volunteers reusing the City's existing Walker Park baskets, sited around the City's plans for the park, with FDGA also sponsoring a professional course designer ($1,000 per 9 holes).

## How it would roll out

PHASE 1

### Walker Park

Once the City accepts the gift, FDGA installs the new baskets, sleeves, tee pad extensions, and signage, coordinated with Parks staff.

PHASE 2

### Kessler design

The Disc Golf Dojo finalizes a layout, which goes through the City's normal review and approval process before anything happens on the ground.

PHASE 3

### Kessler build

With approval in hand, FDGA volunteers prep the site and install the retired Walker Park baskets.

FAYETTEVILLE DISC GOLF ASSOCIATION

## Let's talk it through

Prepared for Fayetteville Parks & Recreation ahead of our meeting — happy to walk through any part of this in person.